



For one week every year, this small town in Germany becomes Mecca for everyone who has any reason to care about technology - business or pleasure.

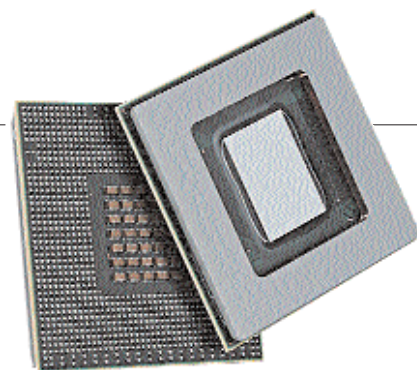
We took a walk through the twenty-seven ridiculously massive halls to bring you some of our favourites from CeBIT 2006



Enter The Cell

A part from the very cool product name, IBM's Cell promises to leave current processors coughing dust in the near future. They've crammed about 234 million transistors in the teeny space of 221 square millimetres, clocked it at 4 GHz, and taken it to a peak performance of 256 GigaFlops. Compare that to the AMD X2, which can only manage 25 GigaFlops, and you'll understand what the fuss is about!

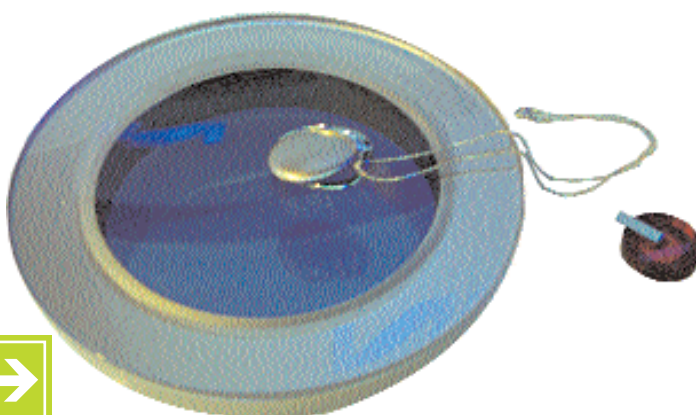
How does it do this? The Cell has - hold your breath - nine processor cores! One 64-bit PowerPC, helped along by eight Synergistic Processing Elements (SPEs), makes The Cell the ultimate processor for intensive gaming and mul-



timedia applications.

Just to show off its capabilities, IBM had it render a realistic human heart that visitors could view with 3D glasses and rotate it interactively. They could even make cross-sections of the heart as they pleased. All this -without even using a graphics card-

Bet Apple's feeling pretty silly for ditching IBM now! Welcome back ~Big Blue~, we've missed you!



Nostalgia And RFID

Do you still look fondly at that watch you got for your birthday so many years ago? In their Resonantware display, NEC showcased a few visionary technologies for the future, including this neat concept called SALA. The idea revolves around the fact that the

many trinkets we own are associated with fond images from the past. So what did NEC do?

By embedding RFID tags in the said trinkets, each of them will be associated with its own set of images and videos, and by placing the object in a tray with an inbuilt display device will now bring up those memories. So if you were to bring in the old watch we mentioned you'd see pictures of the birthday



Crap-tastic Product Of The Year Award



The Charming way of Communication", they called it. If you can't get enough for the good old phone headsets (the kind you only see in phone booths these days), and love your cell phone too, this one's perfect for you.

Retrostar's classic headset plugs into your cell phone's hands-free to give you the feeling that you're back in the 80s while still using twenty-first century technology.

You also get a version which plugs into your PC for VoIP calls.

Sensible people dismiss the idea with a cruel laugh, but for all its uselessness, we still want one!